

A course in language creation



Conlangs University

Phonology 4

Sound change



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Assignment

We're more than 6500 words later, which means it's time to try to summarise what you've learnt in this document. There's been an awful lot of technical terms so feel free to look up and check if you forgot something. The following homework features some general exercises to help you memorise how everything works, as well as some exercises specific to your conlang.

1. The following changes are attested in real languages. Try to describe them as well as you can:

Example: $n > m$ / $_C[+labial]$ (/n/ undergoes regressive assimilation of labial features)

$p\ t\ k > f\ \theta\ x$

$e > a$ / $_C[+resonant]a$

$sj\ zj > \int\ ʒ$

$rs > s$

2. Slightly more difficult: try to analyse which sound changes have happened in the following examples (the order may be important!) - sound change notation plus the category is sufficient:

Example: $mu:si > mi:s$ ($my:si$ [assimilation] $> my:s$ [apocope] $> mi:s$ [unrounding])

$kida > giða$

$statjō > staʃon$

$nikto > ipi:to$

$namno > navon$

3. Have a look at the allophones you decided for on your conlang and in which environments they appear. Can you classify them under any of the categories above?
4. Take ten random words from your conlang and try to make ten random sound changes before applying them. What do you see? Are all words affected equally much? Does it happen to merge grammatically distinct forms?